finalization and submission to a press for review. It is worth stating in no uncertain terms that, at this stage in the work, the feedback from respected senior colleagues in such diverse fields as Anthropology, Archeology, Art History, and History – and spanning virtually all of the second millennium CE across western, southern, and central Asia – made the final product that much stronger. Surely, such a practice would be welcomed by all authors, not only for the assured improvement of their books, but also for the enduring conversations that are generated in such well-defined but informal contexts.

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With such good fortune in colleagues, friends and family, I emphasize that any shortcomings in this work are my own.